



Kannada Beku

A designer's guide to the app — what it does, how a learner moves through it, and the look & feel you'll be designing within.

APP OVERVIEW · FOR DESIGNERS

The big picture

Kannada Beku teaches people how to *speak* everyday Kannada — the language of Bengaluru and Karnataka. It's aimed at adults who've moved to the city (or are about to) and want to hold real conversations fast, without slogging through grammar textbooks. It's a phone app, for both iPhone and Android.

Three ideas drive everything:

- **Speak from day one.** Learners practise real phrases, not drills.
- **Never get stuck.** An offline "emergency" section has survival phrases for autos, shops, and the street — usable with no signal and no login.
- **Five minutes a day.** The app rewards small, consistent habits with visible streaks.

The lessons go from L1 to L8, each broken into a few bite-sized parts. Before Lesson 1 there's a short **Beginners Guide** that teaches the sounds and the alphabet. Once a learner has finished something, four little **games** let them play with what they've learned.

How words are shown. Every Kannada word appears three ways — the script (ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ), the *transliteration* (how you'd say it), and the English meaning. That three-layer pattern is everywhere in the app.

How a learner gets around

After a brand splash screen, login (if needed), and a one-time setup for first-timers, the learner lands in the main app — organised around a **bottom bar with four tabs**:

- **Home** — the daily check-in. Where you left off, today's goals, your streak.
- **Learn** — the curriculum: eight lessons plus the Beginners Guide.
- **Games** — the four games to practise with.
- **Profile** — stats, your goal, and settings.

On top of those tabs, full-screen experiences open as needed: the first-time setup, the lesson player, each game, the emergency phrases, the Beginners Guide, and settings.

The four main screens

Home

The screen a returning learner sees most. Near the top is their **streak** — a little flame with a day count. Below that, a warm greeting by name, then the heart of the screen: a card with **three progress rings** for the day (Listening, Speaking, Practising) that fill up as they go. Underneath, a "**continue where you left off**" card drops them back into their next lesson, a **words-learned banner** celebrates their vocabulary, and a quick shortcut reaches the emergency phrases.

Learn

The curriculum laid out as a journey. The **Beginners Guide** sits at the top, then the eight lessons appear as a vertical path. Each shows its state at a glance: **done** lessons get a gold tile and a checkmark; the **active** lesson is highlighted in red with a play button (and a segmented bar if it has parts); **locked** lessons are faded with a lock that gently explains why.

#	Lesson	What it covers
1	Greetings	Hello, and how are you
2	Names	I, you, "my name is"
3	Wanting	I want, I don't want
4	Pointing	This, that, here, there
5	Easy verbs	Come, eat, laugh
6	Questions	Who, what, where
7	Hard verbs	See, do, play
8	Putting it together	Combining everything

Games

A playground of four games. They stay **locked until the learner finishes their first lesson part** — there's no point quizzing someone on words they haven't met. Locked games look dimmed, and a friendly note reminds everyone that games only use phrases already learned.

Profile

The "how am I doing" screen: name and start date, a big **overall progress** figure blending lessons and games, two stat cards (lessons completed, words learned), the **goal** they set during setup, and access to settings (reminders, audio, help) plus sign-out.

The four games

Every game only uses vocabulary the learner has already seen, and they all end on the same tidy results screen with a score and a "play again or move on" choice.

Game	What the learner does
Quick Quiz	A fast multiple-choice round against a timer — see a Kannada word, tap the right meaning before the clock runs out.
Dictation	Hear a phrase, then <i>build</i> it in Kannada by tapping syllable tiles together. Accepts a few reasonable spellings.
Opposites	See a word and choose its opposite from four options.
Conversations	A little roleplay — a character speaks, the learner picks a Kannada reply, and the conversation unfolds turn by turn.

There's also the **Emergency phrases** screen — not a game, but an important safety net. Survival phrases sorted by urgency and grouped by situation (auto, shop, street). Each shows what to *say*, what to *show* (the script), what it means, and a button to hear it. It works fully offline and needs no login — for the moment someone is actually stuck on the street.

What a lesson feels like

A lesson isn't a wall of text — it's a guided sequence that eases the learner in and builds up:

1. **Set the scene** — here's the situation you'll use this in.
2. **Meet the words** — a small set of new vocabulary.
3. **Practise the words** — listen and say them back.
4. **Meet the phrases** — full sentences, with a note on how they work.

5. **Practise the phrases** — try the sentences.
6. **Recap** — a quick review.
7. **Real world** — a little challenge to use it for real.
8. **Done** — a celebration and a clear next step.

Longer lessons split into parts, so a learner can do just one in a spare five minutes. Finishing any part keeps their streak alive and helps unlock the games.

How progress is shown

- **Streak** — how many days in a row they've shown up. The little flame.
- **Daily rings** — separate rings for Listening, Speaking, and Practising, each with its own daily target, reset every night.
- **Words learned** — a growing count of vocabulary collected.
- **Overall progress** — one headline percentage on Profile, blending lessons completed with game performance.

The look & feel

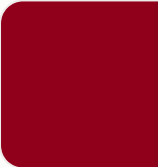
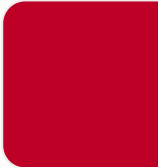
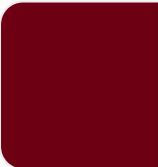
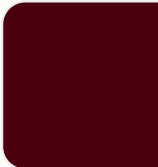
The app has a mature, well-established visual style with a name: "**Chunky Kit.**" It's deliberate and consistent, and most of it is considered settled — so think of this as the world you're designing *within*, rather than a blank page.

The personality. Bold, rounded, and tactile. The signature move is a "lip" — buttons and cards have a solid colored bottom edge, and when you press one, the top face physically drops onto the lip, like pressing a real, chunky key. Playful and satisfying rather than flat.

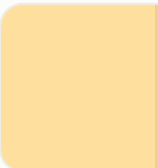
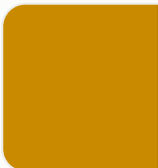
Separation without lines. Instead of borders, the design shifts the background tone slightly. There's really only one faint hairline in the whole app, and it's barely there on purpose — "felt, not seen."

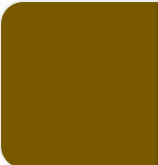
The colors. The palette comes straight from Karnataka's identity: a deep **Mysore red** and a warm **turmeric gold** on soft sandstone-cream backgrounds. Red is for action and importance; gold for reward and encouragement; a burnt orange signals "locked" or "offline." Text is always a warm near-black. Firm rule: **no blues, greens, teals, or corals** — the warmth is part of the brand. Here are the exact tokens:

BRAND — MYSORE RED

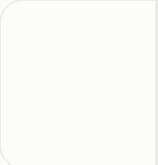
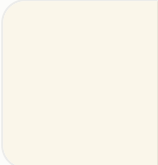
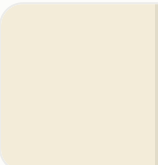
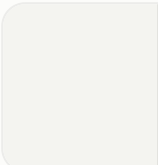
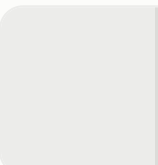
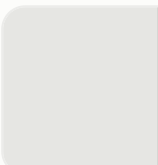
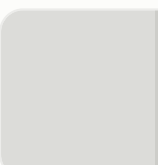
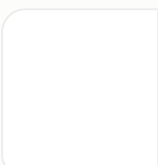
	Primary #91001b CTAs, active states, gradient start		Primary Container #be0027 Gradient end, primary button fill
	Red Lip #6e0014 Bottom "lip" on red buttons		Red Lip Deep #4a000e Deepest maroon lip (Conversations)

BRAND — TURMERIC GOLD

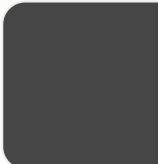
	Secondary Container #fdc003 Secondary actions, success		Gold Bright #ffd24d Lighter gold highlight, gradients
	Secondary Fixed #ffdf9e Selected chips, sun-drenched accents		Gold Lip #c98a00 Lip / ring on gold buttons

	Secondary #785900 Dark gold text, mandala fill		On Secondary Container #6c5000 Text on gold container
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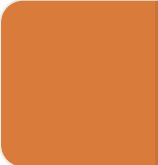
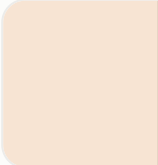
SURFACES — WARM NEUTRAL RAMP

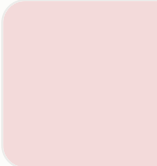
	Surface #fcfcfa Root page background (near-white)		Surface Cream #faf6ea Chunky-kit page background
	Surface Cream Low #f3ecd9 Recessed zones behind cards		Container Low #f4f4f0 Secondary zones, tab bar
	Container High #ececea Selection chips, badges		Container Highest #e6e6e3 Interactive cards
	Surface Dim #dcdcd9 Lifted-card backdrop, locked		Container Lowest #ffffff Glassmorphism (70% + blur)

TEXT — WARM SANDSTONE

	On Surface #1b1d0e Primary text (never pure black)		Tertiary #464646 Captions, labels, inactive tabs
	Text Faint #908d76 Hints, locked labels		On Primary #ffffff Text on red / dark fills

FUNCTIONAL ACCENTS — WARM-ONLY STATES

	Warning Container #d97b3a Burnt orange — locked / warning		Warning Container Low #f7e4d3 Caution / lock tile background
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	On Warning #3a1d07 Ink-brown text on warning fills		Interactive Secondary #b8956a Warm tan-brown — secondary action
	Interactive Secondary Lip #7e6440 Tan lip		Error Container Low #f3dada Pale red — error card / toast bg

The one gradient. A single brand gradient — red **#be0027** → **#91001b** at ~152° — is used *only* on the Home hero card, the Profile avatar, the Emergency header, and the auth background. Two near-invisible overlay tints also exist: **hairline** rgba(27,29,14,0.08) (the one faint border) and **cardLip** rgba(27,29,14,0.18) (the lip on white/neutral cards).

Typography

Three typefaces, each with a clear job. Headings are big and tight; body text is calm and readable.

Baloo Tamma 2
Rounded display

titles · big
numbers ·
buttons

Namaskāra!

DM Sans
Clean sans

body · labels ·
transliteration

Let's build your fluency today.

Noto Sans Kannada
Script only

Kannada glyphs

ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ

Approximate sizes: hero 30 · screen title 24 · big number 28 · card heading 18 · button 16.5 · body 14 · transliteration 20 · eyebrow 11 (uppercase, tracked). Every size scales to the device automatically.

Spacing & shape

- **Spacing scale:** 4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 20 · 24 · 32
- **Corner radius:** 8 (chips) · 14 (cards) · **16 (default chunky)** · 20 (hero) · full (pills)

Motion

Small, springy touches — the press-and-drop of a button, rings sweeping as they fill, the streak flame's wiggle, an audio button pulsing as it plays. All of it politely disappears if the learner has "reduce motion" turned on.

Already-built building blocks

There's a healthy kit of ready-made pieces — chunky buttons, the floating tab bar, progress rings, the streak pill, audio buttons, and a full set of "loading / went wrong / offline / nothing here yet" screens. Reach for these rather than building new ones where you can.

Want to go deeper? The authoritative design spec lives in `docs/foundation/DESIGN.md`, with a companion for modals in `docs/foundation/MODALS.md`. The exact color, type, and spacing values live in the `constants` folder; reusable building blocks are in `components/ui` and `components/states`.

Note: most of the design is intentionally **locked**, and colors and styles are shared across the whole app — a single tweak ripples everywhere. Worth a quick check-in with the team before reworking a core token or pattern.